

10.7 Characteristics of Household Heads who Lives in One Person Households

In Sri Lanka, there are 640,704 one-person households (Table 10.3). Among the household heads living in such households, 370,229 are aged 60 years and over. Of these elderly household heads, 71.3 percent are female, while 28.7 percent are male. As indicated in Table 10.9, within the population aged 60 years and over, the number of female household heads living alone exceeds that of males across all age groups. Notably, in the age group of 70 years and over, the number of males living alone is approximately one-third of the corresponding number of females.

Table 10.10: Number and Percentage Distribution of Individuals in One Person Households Aged 60 Years and Over, by Sex and Age Group, 2024

Age Group	Number of Household Heads and Percentage		
	Total	Male	Female
Total	370,229	106,102	264,127
	100.0	28.7	71.3
60 - 64	79,253	27,935	51,318
	100.0	35.2	64.8
65 - 69	87,792	25,963	61,829
	100.0	29.6	70.4
70 - 74	88,157	22,660	65,497
	100.0	25.7	74.3
75 - 79	64,989	16,259	48,730
	100.0	25.0	75.0
80 & over	50,038	13,285	36,753
	100.0	26.5	73.5

The distribution of individuals living in one-person households aged 60 years and over, by sex and age group, is shown in Figure 10.3.

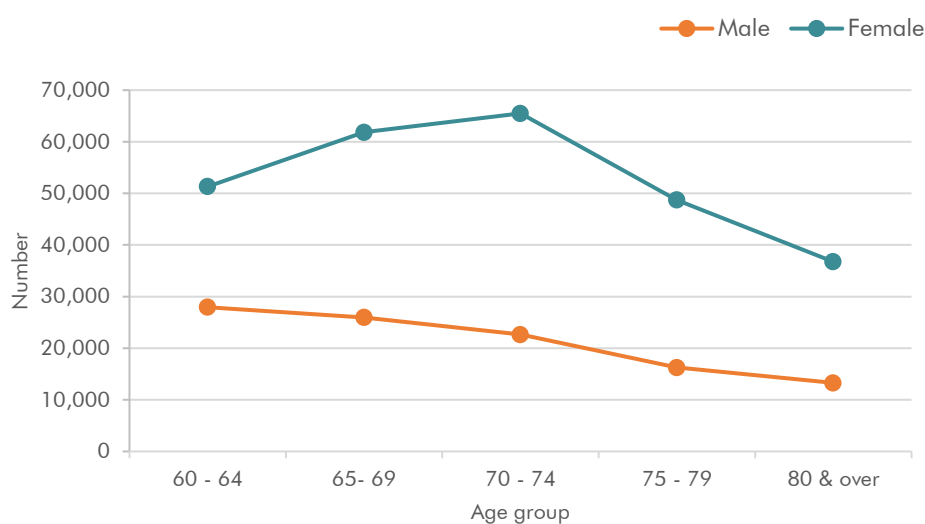


Figure 10.3 : Distribution of Elderly Household Heads Living in One Person Households by Sex and Age Group, 2024

Figure 10.3 clearly shows that, when elderly one-person households (aged 60 years and over) are analyzed by age group, the number of females is significantly higher than that of males across all age groups.